

# Burtons Menu

Full Recipe Collection — Sept 16 to Oct 31, 2026

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## TABLE OF CONTENTS

Week of Sep 13 (partial week) — Herb-Roasted Chicken, Chicken Cacciatore, Chicken Parmigiana, Chicken with Mushrooms and Shallots. Dessert: Almond Blueberry-Peach Cobbler. Cocktail: Whiskey Sour.

Week of Sep 20 — Kalamata Lemon Chicken, Oven-Baked Pork Chops, Farmer's Casserole. Dessert: Apple Crisp. Cocktail: Spiked Apple Cider.

Week of Sep 27 — Pork Tenderloin with Rosemary Peaches, Pork Medallions with Fennel and Pancetta, Mustard and Herb Pork Loin, Beef Pot Roast. Dessert: Cinnamon-Pecan Stuffed Apples. Cocktail: Sidecar.

Week of Oct 4 — Steak with Creamy Onion Sauce, Classic Pot Roast, Balsamic-Glazed Flank Steak with Fall Fruit Salsa, Baked Fish, Shrimp Scampi. Dessert: Caramel Flans. Cocktail: Manhattan.

Week of Oct 11 — Cioppino, Herb-Rubbed Bison Sirloin Tip Roast, Apple-Bison Burgers. Dessert: Dark Chocolate Brownies. Cocktail: Mulled Wine.

Week of Oct 18 — Breakfast Pizza, Farfalle with Mushrooms and Spinach, Vegetarian Lasagna. Dessert: Molten Chocolate Cakes. Cocktail: Cosmopolitan.

Week of Oct 25 — Chicken Marsala, Chicken Piccata, Chicken Enchiladas. Dessert: Pumpkin Bread Pudding. Cocktail: Vodka Gimlet.

## Week of Sep 13 (partial week)

### DINNERS THIS WEEK

## Herb-Roasted Chicken

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 467*

PREP: 20 min | ROAST: 75 min at 375°F | STAND: 10 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1 (3½- to 4-pound) whole broiler chicken
- 2 tablespoons butter, melted
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 teaspoon dried basil, crushed
- 1 teaspoon dried sage, crushed
- ½ teaspoon dried thyme, crushed
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon black pepper

### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. Rinse chicken body cavity; pat dry with paper towels. Skewer neck skin to back; tie legs to tail. Twist wing tips under back. Place chicken, breast side up, on a rack in a shallow roasting pan. Brush with melted butter; rub with garlic.
2. In a small bowl stir together basil, sage, thyme, salt, and pepper; rub onto chicken. Insert a meat thermometer into center of an inside thigh muscle (thermometer should not touch bone).
3. Roast, uncovered, for 75 to 90 minutes or until drumsticks move easily in sockets and chicken is done (at least 170°F). Remove chicken from oven. Cover; let stand for 10 minutes before carving.

## Chicken Cacciatore

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 469*

PREP: 30 min | COOK: 20 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 8 small bone-in chicken thighs (about 2 pounds total), skinned
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 3 cups sliced fresh cremini mushrooms
- 1 large green sweet pepper, seeded and cut into bite-size strips
- ⅓ cup finely chopped carrot (1 small)
- 3 cloves garlic, minced

- ½ cup dry white wine or chicken broth
- 1 (28-ounce) can diced tomatoes, undrained
- 1½ cups frozen small whole onions
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano, crushed
- 2 tablespoons balsamic vinegar
- Hot cooked broken lasagna noodles or desired pasta
- 10 pitted Kalamata olives, halved (optional)
- ⅓ cup snipped fresh Italian parsley (optional)

### Instructions

1. Sprinkle chicken lightly with salt and cracked black pepper. In a large skillet heat oil over medium heat. Add chicken; cook just until browned, turning once. Remove from skillet.
2. Add mushrooms, sweet pepper, carrot, and garlic to the skillet. Cook over medium heat for 4 minutes, stirring occasionally. Remove from heat. Carefully add wine. Return to heat. Simmer, uncovered, until wine is nearly evaporated. Stir in tomatoes, onions, oregano, and 1 teaspoon coarsely ground black pepper.
3. Return chicken to skillet. Simmer, covered, about 20 minutes or until chicken is done (at least 175°F). Stir in vinegar. Season to taste with additional salt. Serve with hot cooked lasagna noodles. If desired, sprinkle with olives and parsley.

## Chicken Parmigiana

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 473*

PREP: 30 min | COOK: 14 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1 tablespoon butter or margarine
- ½ cup chopped onion (1 small)
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- 1 (14.5-ounce) can diced tomatoes, undrained
- ½ teaspoon sugar
- ⅛ teaspoon salt
- Dash black pepper
- ¼ cup snipped fresh basil
- 4 skinless, boneless chicken breast halves (6 to 8 ounces each)
- ⅓ cup seasoned fine dry bread crumbs
- 4 tablespoons grated Parmesan cheese
- ½ teaspoon dried oregano, crushed
- 1 egg, lightly beaten

- 2 tablespoons milk
- 3 tablespoons olive oil or vegetable oil
- ¼ cup shredded mozzarella cheese (1 ounce)

### Instructions

1. For sauce, in a medium saucepan melt butter over medium heat. Add onion and garlic; cook until tender. Carefully stir in the tomatoes, sugar, salt, and pepper. Bring to boiling; reduce heat. Simmer, uncovered, about 10 minutes or to desired consistency, stirring occasionally. Stir in basil. Set aside; keep warm.
2. Meanwhile, place each chicken breast half between two pieces of plastic wrap. Using the flat side of a meat mallet, pound chicken lightly to about ¼ inch thick. Discard plastic wrap.
3. In a shallow bowl stir together bread crumbs, 3 tablespoons of the Parmesan cheese, and the oregano. In a second bowl stir together the egg and milk. Dip chicken into egg mixture and into crumb mixture to coat.
4. In a very large skillet cook chicken in hot oil over medium heat for 2 to 3 minutes per side or until golden. Transfer chicken to platter.
5. Spoon sauce over chicken. Top with mozzarella cheese and the remaining 1 tablespoon Parmesan cheese. Let stand about 2 minutes or until cheese melts.

## Chicken with Mushrooms and Shallots

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 269*

PREP: 15 min | COOK: 6 to 8 hours on Low | SERVES 4 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Weeknight Hero

### Ingredients

- 1 tablespoon unsalted butter, at room temperature, or extra-virgin olive oil
- 4 cups cremini mushrooms, thinly sliced
- 2 teaspoons fresh thyme
- 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 shallots, minced
- 5 tablespoons dry sherry or Chicken Stock (or store-bought)
- 4 (6-ounce) bone-in, skinless chicken thighs
- ¼ teaspoon sea salt
- Freshly ground black pepper

### Instructions

1. Grease a 4-quart slow cooker with the butter.
2. Place the mushrooms, thyme, garlic, and shallots in the slow cooker, tossing them gently to combine. Pour in the sherry.
3. Season the chicken with the salt and pepper and place the thighs on top of the mushroom mixture.

4. Cover and cook on low for 6 to 8 hours, or until the chicken is tender and reads at least 165°F on a food thermometer.

*EXTRA EASY: You can often find sliced mushrooms at the grocery store. This could shave up to 10 minutes off your preparation time. You can use a mix of cremini and button mushrooms in this recipe if you'd like.*

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK

### Dessert: Almond Blueberry-Peach Cobbler

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 491*

PREP: 15 min | COOK: 2 hours on High | SERVES 4 as printed (2x recipe below — serves 8) | Gluten-Free, Vegan

#### Ingredients

- 10 tablespoons coconut oil, divided ( $\frac{3}{8}$  cup + 2 Tbsp)
- 6 large fresh peaches, peeled and sliced
- 4 cups frozen blueberries
- 2 cups almond flour
- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 2 tablespoons coconut sugar
- 2 teaspoons ground cinnamon
- 1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract
- Pinch ground nutmeg (about  $\frac{1}{8}$  tsp)

#### Instructions

1. Grease the bottom of a 3-quart slow cooker with 2 tablespoons of the coconut oil.
2. Arrange the peaches and blueberries in the bottom of the slow cooker.
3. In a bowl, stir together the almond flour, oats, remaining 8 tablespoons coconut oil, maple syrup, coconut sugar, cinnamon, vanilla extract, and nutmeg until crumbly. Gently crumble the topping over the fruit in the slow cooker.
4. Place 3 paper towels on the top of the slow cooker to absorb moisture, and cover. Cook on high for 2 hours, until the fruits are bubbly. Serve.

*INGREDIENT TIP: Not all oats are gluten-free. Although the oat grain itself doesn't contain gluten, some oats are processed on the same equipment as wheat. Make sure to read the labels.*

### Cocktail: Whiskey Sour

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 72*

Makes 1 serving

**Ingredients**

- ¼ cup (2 oz) bourbon
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) lime juice
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) lemon juice
- 1 tablespoon sugar
- Ice cubes
- Orange slice and maraschino cherry (optional garnish)

**Instructions**

1. In a rocks glass combine bourbon, lime juice, lemon juice, and sugar. Stir until sugar dissolves. Add ice cubes. If desired, garnish with an orange slice and a maraschino cherry.

## Week of Sep 20

### DINNERS THIS WEEK Kalamata Lemon

## Chicken

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 479*

PREP: 10 min | BAKE: 35 min at 400°F | MAKES: 4 servings

#### Ingredients

- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 4 large skinless, boneless chicken thighs (1 to 1¼ pounds)
- 1 (14.5-ounce) can chicken broth
- ⅔ cup dried orzo (Rosamaria)
- ½ cup pitted Kalamata olives, drained
- ½ of a lemon, cut into wedges or chunks
- 1 tablespoon lemon juice
- 1 teaspoon dried Greek seasoning or dried oregano, crushed
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon black pepper
- Hot chicken broth (optional)
- Snipped fresh oregano (optional)

#### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. In a 4-quart Dutch oven heat oil over medium-high heat. Add chicken; cook about 5 minutes or until browned, turning once. Stir in broth, orzo, olives, lemon wedges, lemon juice, Greek seasoning, salt, and pepper. Bring to boiling. Transfer mixture to a 2-quart rectangular baking dish.
2. Bake, covered, about 35 minutes or until chicken is done (at least 170°F). If desired, serve in shallow bowls with additional hot broth and top with oregano.

## Oven-Baked Pork Chops

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 400*

PREP: 20 min | BAKE: 14 min at 350°F | STAND: 5 min | MAKES: 4 servings

#### Ingredients

- 4 bone-in pork loin chops, cut 1¼ inches thick (about 3 pounds total), or 4 boneless pork loin chops, cut 1¼ inches thick (about 2½ pounds total)
- ¼ teaspoon salt

- ¼ teaspoon black pepper
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- Salt and black pepper (optional)
- — Cranberry-Apple topping: 1 cup chopped apple, 2 minced shallots, 2 tablespoons butter, ⅓ cup dried cranberries, 1 tablespoon snipped fresh sage, 1 tablespoon cider vinegar

### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. Trim fat from chops. Pat chops dry with paper towels. Sprinkle chops with the ¼ teaspoon salt and the ¼ teaspoon pepper.
2. In a very large skillet heat the oil over medium-high heat. Add two bone-in chops or all of the boneless chops. Cook about 6 minutes or until browned, turning to brown evenly. Transfer chops to a 15×10×1-inch baking pan. Repeat with remaining bone-in chops.
3. Bake chops for 14 to 17 minutes or until an instant-read thermometer inserted in chops registers 145°F. Cover and let stand for 5 minutes. Serve chops with topping. If desired, sprinkle with additional salt and pepper.
4. Cranberry-Apple topping: Cook chopped apple and minced shallots in butter for 3 minutes. Stir in dried cranberries. Cook 2 minutes. Stir in fresh sage and cider vinegar.

## Farmer's Casserole

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 133*

PREP: 25 min | BAKE: 40 min at 350°F | STAND: 5 min | MAKES: 6 servings

### Ingredients

- Nonstick cooking spray
- 3 cups frozen shredded hash brown potatoes
- ¾ cup shredded Monterey Jack cheese with jalapeño peppers or shredded cheddar cheese (3ounces)
- 1 cup diced cooked ham, cooked breakfast sausage, or Canadian-style bacon
- ¼ cup sliced green onions (2)
- 4 eggs, beaten, or 1 cup refrigerated or frozen egg product, thawed
- 1½ cups milk or one 12-ounce can evaporated milk or evaporated fat-free milk
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ½ teaspoon black pepper

### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. Coat a 2-quart square baking dish with nonstick cooking spray. Arrange hash brown potatoes evenly in the dish. Sprinkle with cheese, ham, and green onions.
2. In a medium bowl combine eggs, milk, salt, and pepper. Pour egg mixture over layers in dish.



3. Bake, uncovered, for 40 to 45 minutes or until a knife inserted near the center comes out clean. Let stand for 5 minutes before serving.

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK **Dessert: Apple Crisp**

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 272*

PREP: 25 min | BAKE: 35 min at 375°F | MAKES: 6 servings

### Ingredients

- 6 cups sliced, peeled cooking apples
- 3 to 4 tablespoons granulated sugar
- ½ cup regular rolled oats
- ½ cup packed brown sugar
- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon, ginger, or nutmeg
- ¼ cup butter
- ¼ cup chopped nuts or flaked coconut
- Vanilla ice cream (optional)

### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. In a large bowl combine apples and granulated sugar. Transfer apple mixture to a 1½- to 2-quart square baking dish; set aside.
2. For topping, in a medium bowl combine the oats, brown sugar, flour, and cinnamon. Cut in butter until mixture resembles coarse crumbs. Stir in nuts. Sprinkle topping over apple mixture in dish.
3. Bake for 35 to 40 minutes or until apples are tender and topping is golden. If desired, serve warm with ice cream.

## **Cocktail: Spiked Apple Cider**

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 91*

PREP: 5 min | COOK: 1 hour on High | SERVES 6 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Vegetarian

### Ingredients

- 2 tablespoons unsalted butter
- ½ cup packed brown sugar
- ¼ teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
- 6 cups unfiltered apple cider
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 1 cup dark rum

### Instructions

1. Place the butter in a small, microwave-safe bowl or cup and microwave on high for 20 to 30 seconds, until melted. Add the brown sugar and nutmeg and stir until combined. Transfer the butter mixture to a 3-quart slow cooker and add the apple cider and cinnamon sticks.

2. Cover and cook on high for 1 hour, or until the mixture is hot and steaming.
3. Uncover the slow cooker, reduce the heat to low, and stir in the rum. Discard the cinnamon sticks. Serve the cider warm, ladled into mugs.

## Week of Sep 27

### DINNERS THIS WEEK

## Pork Tenderloin with Rosemary Peaches

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 355*

PREP: 15 min | COOK: 6 to 8 hours on Low | SERVES 4 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Weeknight Hero

### Ingredients

- 4 peaches, peeled, pitted, and cut into wedges
- 1 red onion, halved and thinly sliced
- Leaves from 2 rosemary sprigs
- 1 (1¼-pound) pork tenderloin
- ¼ teaspoon sea salt
- Freshly ground black pepper

### Instructions

1. Place the peaches, onion, and rosemary leaves in a 3-quart slow cooker. Stir to combine.
2. Season the pork tenderloin with the salt and a few grinds of black pepper. Place the tenderloin on top of the peach and onion mixture.
3. Cover and cook on low for 6 to 8 hours, until the onion and fruit have softened and the pork is tender. Let the meat rest for 3 minutes before slicing to serve.

*INGREDIENT TIP: Pork no longer has to be cooked until well done, according to the USDA. The recommendation changed in 2011.*

## Pork Medallions with Fennel and Pancetta

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 397*

MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1 pound pork tenderloin, cut into medallions
- Salt and black pepper
- 2 ounces pancetta, chopped
- 1 medium fennel bulb, thinly sliced
- 1 clove garlic, minced
- ½ cup dry white wine or chicken broth
- 1 tablespoon butter
- Snipped fresh fennel fronds (optional)

**Instructions**

1. Season pork medallions with salt and pepper. In a large skillet cook pancetta until crisp; remove and set aside, reserving drippings.
2. Cook pork medallions in reserved drippings until browned and cooked through; remove from skillet.
3. Add fennel and garlic to skillet; cook until tender. Add wine; simmer until slightly reduced. Stir in butter. Return pork and pancetta to skillet; heat through. If desired, sprinkle with fennel fronds.

# Mustard and Herb Pork Loin

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 370*

MAKES: 6 servings, slow cooker

## Ingredients

- 1 (2- to 3-pound) boneless pork loin roast
- ¼ cup Dijon mustard
- 2 tablespoons honey
- 2 teaspoons dried herbes de Provence or Italian seasoning
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- Salt and black pepper

## Instructions

1. Season pork loin with salt and pepper; place in slow cooker.
2. Stir together mustard, honey, herbs, and garlic; spread over pork.
3. Cover and cook on low for 6 to 7 hours or until pork is tender and reads at least 145°F.

# Beef Pot Roast

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 385*

PREP: 30 min | COOK: 105 min | MAKES: 6 servings

## Ingredients

- 1 (2½- to 3-pound) beef chuck arm pot roast, chuck shoulder pot roast, or beef chuck seven-bone pot roast • 2 tablespoons vegetable oil
- ¾ cup Liquid (beef broth, or ½ cup beef broth plus ¼ cup dry red wine)
- 1 tablespoon Liquid Seasoning (e.g. Worcestershire sauce)
- 1 teaspoon Dried Herb (e.g. thyme or rosemary), crushed
- 1 pound Potatoes (e.g. red or Yukon), halved or quartered
- 1 pound Vegetables (e.g. carrots, onion wedges), cut into 1- to 2-inch pieces
- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- Salt and black pepper

## Instructions

1. Trim fat from meat. Sprinkle meat with salt and black pepper. In a 4- to 6-quart Dutch oven brown roast on all sides in hot oil. Drain off fat. Combine desired Liquid, Liquid Seasoning, Dried Herb, and ½ teaspoon salt. Pour over roast. Bring to boiling; reduce heat. Simmer, covered, for 1 hour.
2. Meanwhile, prep potatoes as needed. Add Potatoes and Vegetables to Dutch oven with meat. Return to boiling; reduce heat. Simmer, covered, for 45 to 60 minutes more or until meat and vegetables are tender. Using a slotted spoon, transfer meat and vegetables to a platter, reserving juices in Dutch oven. Keep warm.
3. For gravy, measure cooking juices; skim off fat. If necessary, add enough water to juices to equal 1½ cups. Return to Dutch oven. Stir together ¼ cup cold water and flour until smooth. Stir into juices in pan. Cook and stir over medium heat until thickened and bubbly. Cook and stir for 1 minute more. Serve gravy with meat and vegetables.

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK

### Dessert: Cinnamon-Pecan Stuffed Apples

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 494*

PREP: 15 min | COOK: 5 hours on Low | SERVES 4 as printed (2x recipe below — serves 8) | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Vegetarian

## Ingredients

- 1 cup chopped pecans
- 4 tablespoons vegan brown sugar
- 2 teaspoons ground cinnamon
- ½ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ¼ teaspoon sea salt

- 8 apples
- 4 teaspoons unsalted butter
- 1 cup apple cider

### Instructions

1. In a bowl, combine the pecans, brown sugar, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt.
2. Peel a strip around the top of each apple to prevent them from splitting as they cook. Using an apple corer, remove the core from the top and discard.
3. In a 3-quart slow cooker, place the apples upright. (You may need to slice a little off the base to help them stand up straight.) Gently stuff the apples with the sugar mixture. Dot the tops with ½ teaspoon of butter each.
4. Gently pour the apple cider around the bottom of the apples.
5. Cover and cook on low for 5 hours, or until the apples are tender and fragrant.

## Cocktail: Sidecar

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 72*

Makes 1 serving

### Ingredients

- Superfine sugar (for rim, optional)
- ¼ cup (2 oz) brandy
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) orange liqueur
- Ice cubes
- Lemon peel twist (garnish)

### Instructions

1. If desired, wet the rim of a chilled glass with water and dip into sugar to coat. In a cocktail shaker combine brandy, lemon juice, and orange liqueur. Add ice cubes; cover and shake until very cold. Strain into prepared glass or a glass filled with ice. Garnish with a lemon peel twist.



## Week of Oct 4

### DINNERS THIS WEEK

## Steak with Creamy Onion Sauce

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 380*

PREP: 20 min | STAND: 35 min | BROIL: 12 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 4 beef ribeye steaks, cut about 1 inch thick
- 1 tablespoon butter
- 1 cup coarsely chopped sweet onion (such as Maui or Walla Walla) (1 large)
- ½ cup light sour cream
- 1 tablespoon capers, drained
- 2 teaspoons Montreal steak seasoning

### Instructions

1. Allow steaks to stand at room temperature for 30 minutes.
2. Meanwhile, for sauce, in a large skillet melt butter over medium-low heat. Add onion; cook, covered, for 13 to 15 minutes or until onion is tender, stirring occasionally. Uncover; increase heat to medium-high. Cook and stir for 3 to 5 minutes or until onion is golden. Reduce heat to medium-low. Stir in sour cream, capers, and ½ teaspoon of the steak seasoning. Cook until heated through (do not boil); set sauce aside.
3. Preheat broiler. Trim fat from steaks. Sprinkle steaks with the remaining 1½ teaspoons steak seasoning. Place steaks on the unheated rack of a broiler pan. Broil steaks 3 to 4 inches from the heat for 12 to 14 minutes for medium rare (145°F) or 15 to 18 minutes for medium (160°F), turning once halfway through broiling. Cover steaks with foil; let stand for 5 minutes before serving. Transfer steaks to serving plates. Spoon some of the sauce over steaks. Pass remaining sauce.

## Classic Pot Roast

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 410*

PREP: 15 min | COOK: 8 to 10 hours on Low | SERVES 6 | Gluten-Free, Weeknight Hero

### Ingredients

- 1 (3- to 4-pound) beef chuck roast
- 1 teaspoon sea salt
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- ½ cup dry red wine

- 4 large carrots
- 1 yellow onion, cut crosswise in rings
- 6 red potatoes, halved
- 1 rosemary sprig
- 1 cup beef broth

### Instructions

1. Pat the beef dry with paper towels. Season the beef on all sides with the salt and pepper.
2. Place a large skillet over medium-high heat and add the olive oil. Once hot, add the beef and brown the meat on all sides for about 10 minutes total. Remove the beef and set aside.
3. Add the wine to the skillet and bring to a simmer, using a spatula or wooden spoon to scrape the browned bits and drippings from the bottom of the pan.
4. Place the carrots, onion, potatoes, and rosemary in a 5-quart slow cooker. Pour in the wine and drippings from the skillet. Arrange the browned beef on top of the vegetables.
5. Cover and cook on low for 8 to 10 hours, or until the meat is very tender.
6. Discard the rosemary sprig. Slice the meat against the grain and serve alongside the cooked vegetables and potatoes.

*INGREDIENT TIP: Slicing meat “against the grain” is the best way to ensure a tender result. The “grain” in meat is just the way the fibers run, so cut perpendicular to the fibers.*

## Balsamic-Glazed Flank Steak with Fall Fruit Salsa

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 386*

STAND: 35 min | PREP: 20 min | BROIL: 17 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1 pound beef flank steak
- 3 tablespoons balsamic vinegar
- 1½ cups chopped red and/or green apples
- 1 cup chopped pear
- ¼ cup dried cranberries
- 2 teaspoons sugar
- ¼ teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Salt and black pepper

### Instructions

1. Allow steak to stand at room temperature for 30 minutes. Preheat broiler. Trim fat from steak. Score both sides of steak in a diamond pattern by making shallow diagonal cuts at 1-inch intervals. Sprinkle both sides of steak with salt and

black pepper. Place steak on the unheated rack of broiler pan. Broil 3 to 4 inches from heat for 16 minutes, turning once. Brush both sides of steak with 1 tablespoon of the balsamic vinegar; broil for 1 to 5 minutes more or until medium (160°F). Cover with foil; let steak stand for 5 minutes before slicing.

2. For fruit salsa, in a bowl combine apples, pear, and cranberries. Stir in the remaining 2 tablespoons balsamic vinegar, the sugar, and cinnamon. Thinly slice steak; serve with salsa.

## Baked Fish

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 302*

PREP: 20 min | BAKE: 12 min at 425°F | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1½ pounds fresh or frozen skinless fish fillets (catfish, grouper, red snapper, salmon, or tilapia)
- 2 eggs or egg whites, lightly beaten
- 1 tablespoon milk or water
- Crumbs (pick one): 1 cup crushed Italian-seasoned or garlic croutons; 1 cup panko breadcrumbs; 1 cup crushed saltine crackers; 1 cup crushed rich round crackers; or ½ cup shredded coconut and ½ cup panko
- Seasoning (pick one): Italian — 1 teaspoon dried Italian seasoning, ½ teaspoon salt, ¼teaspoon black pepper • Nonstick cooking spray
- Topping (pick one): tartar sauce or purchased basil pesto

### Instructions

1. Thaw fish fillets if frozen. Preheat oven to 425°F. Line a large baking sheet with foil. Lightly grease foil; set aside.
2. Rinse fish; pat dry with paper towels. Cut fish into four serving-size pieces if necessary. In a shallow dish combine eggs and milk. In a second shallow dish combine Crumbs and Seasoning. Dip fish into egg mixture; coat fish with crumb mixture. Place on prepared baking sheet. Coat fish with cooking spray.
3. Bake for 12 to 15 minutes or until fish flakes easily when tested with a fork. Serve with Topping.

## Shrimp Scampi

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 310*

START TO FINISH: 20 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- 1½ pounds fresh or frozen large shrimp
- 8 ounces dried angel hair pasta
- ¼ cup butter, melted
- ¼ cup olive oil
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ⅛ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- 2 tablespoons snipped fresh parsley
- 1 teaspoon finely shredded lemon peel
- Lemon wedges (optional)

## Instructions

1. Thaw shrimp if frozen. Peel and devein shrimp, leaving tails intact, if desired. Rinse shrimp; pat dry with paper towels. Set shrimp aside.
2. In a large pot cook pasta according to package directions; drain. Return pasta to pot.
3. Meanwhile, in a large skillet heat butter, olive oil, and garlic over medium-high heat. Add shrimp, salt, and crushed red pepper to skillet. Cook and stir about 3 minutes or until shrimp are opaque. Stir in parsley and lemon peel. Add shrimp mixture to pasta in pot; toss to combine. If desired, serve shrimp mixture with lemon wedges.

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK **Dessert: Caramel**

### Flans

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 280*

PREP: 25 min | STAND: 10 min | BAKE: 30 min at 325°F | MAKES: 4 flans as printed (2x recipe below — makes 8)

#### Ingredients

- $\frac{3}{4}$  cup sugar (for caramelizing)
- 6 eggs, lightly beaten
- 3 cups half-and-half or light cream
- $\frac{3}{4}$  cup sugar (for custard)
- 2 teaspoons vanilla
- Ground nutmeg (optional)

#### Instructions

1. To caramelize sugar, in a small heavy skillet heat sugar over medium-high heat until it begins to melt, shaking the skillet occasionally; do not stir. When the sugar starts to melt, reduce heat to low and cook about 5 minutes or until all of the sugar melts, stirring as needed with a wooden spoon. Immediately divide the caramelized sugar among custard cups; tilt cups to coat bottoms. Let stand for 10 minutes.
2. Meanwhile, preheat oven to 325°F. Combine eggs, half-and-half, sugar, and vanilla. Beat until well combined but not foamy. Place custard cups in a baking dish. Divide egg mixture among custard cups. If desired, sprinkle with nutmeg. Place baking dish on oven rack. Pour boiling water into baking dish around custard cups to a depth of 1 inch. Bake for 30 to 40 minutes or until a knife inserted near the centers comes out clean.
3. Remove custard cups from water. Cool slightly on a wire rack and unmold. (Or cool completely in cups. Cover; chill until serving time.) Using a sharp knife, loosen flan from sides of cups. Invert a plate over each cup; turn plate and cup over together. Remove custard cups.

### Cocktail: Manhattan

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 72*

Makes 1 serving

**Ingredients**

- ¼ cup (2 oz) bourbon
- 1 tablespoon (½ oz) vermouth
- Dash bitters
- Ice cubes
- Maraschino cherry (garnish)

**Instructions**

1. In a cocktail shaker combine bourbon, vermouth, and bitters. Add ice cubes; cover and shake until very cold. Strain into a chilled glass or an ice-filled glass. Garnish with a maraschino cherry.

## Week of Oct 11

### DINNERS THIS WEEK Cioppino

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 221*

PREP: 20 min | COOK: 8 hours on Low, plus 30 min on High | SERVES 6 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie

#### Ingredients

- 1 (15-ounce) can tomato sauce
- 7 cups fish stock or Chicken Stock (or store-bought)
- 1 yellow onion, chopped
- 1 tablespoon Italian seasoning
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon sea salt
- ¼ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- Pinch red pepper flakes
- 8 ounces skinless cod or halibut fillets, cut into 1-inch pieces
- 1 pound medium (41- to 50-count) shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 1 pound mussels, cleaned and debearded
- ¼ cup chopped fresh parsley
- Grated zest of 1 lemon

#### Instructions

1. Place the tomato sauce, stock, onion, Italian seasoning, garlic powder, salt, black pepper, and red pepper flakes in a 4- to 5-quart slow cooker. Stir to combine.
2. Cover and cook on low for 8 hours. Stir in the fish, shrimp, mussels, parsley, and lemon zest.

### Herb-Rubbed Bison Sirloin Tip Roast

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 408*

PREP: 20 min | ROAST: 75 min at 375°F | STAND: 15 min | MAKES: 8 servings

#### Ingredients

- 1 tablespoon paprika
- 2 teaspoons kosher salt or sea salt, or 1 teaspoon salt
- 1 teaspoon garlic powder
- ½ teaspoon dried oregano, crushed
- ½ teaspoon dried thyme, crushed
- ½ teaspoon black pepper

- ½ teaspoon onion powder
- ½ teaspoon cayenne pepper
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 (3- to 3½-pound) boneless bison (buffalo) sirloin tip roast

### Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. In a small bowl combine paprika, salt, garlic powder, oregano, thyme, black pepper, onion powder, and cayenne pepper. Stir in oil until well combined.
2. Trim fat from roast. Spread oil mixture over meat. Place meat on a rack in a shallow roasting pan. Insert an oven-going meat thermometer into center of roast.
3. Roast, uncovered, for 15 minutes. Reduce oven temperature to 300°F. Roast for 60 to 65 minutes more or until meat thermometer registers 135°F (medium rare). Cover with foil and let stand for 15 minutes. Temperature of the meat will rise during standing. Thinly slice meat across the grain to serve.

## Apple-Bison Burgers

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 408*

PREP: 45 min | COOK: 8 min | MAKES: 4 burgers

### Ingredients

- 1 recipe Cantaloupe and Strawberry Relish (see below)
- ½ cup finely chopped Granny Smith apple
- ¼ cup finely chopped celery
- ¼ cup finely chopped onion
- 1 tablespoon vegetable oil
- 2 tablespoons ketchup
- ¾ teaspoon Jamaican jerk seasoning
- ½ teaspoon salt
- ⅛ teaspoon black or cayenne pepper
- 1 pound ground bison (buffalo)
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- ¼ cup mayonnaise
- 4 slices Texas toast or ¾-inch slices rustic Italian bread, toasted
- Red-tipped leaf lettuce
- — Cantaloupe and Strawberry Relish: ½ cup chopped cantaloupe or peeled peaches; ½ cup chopped fresh strawberries; 2 tablespoons finely chopped red onion; 2 tablespoons finely chopped green sweet pepper; 1 tablespoon snipped fresh cilantro; 2 teaspoons snipped fresh mint; ½ teaspoon finely shredded lemon or lime peel; 1 tablespoon lemon or lime juice



## Instructions

1. Prepare Cantaloupe and Strawberry Relish (combine all relish ingredients; toss lightly; let stand 30 minutes or chill). In a medium saucepan cook apple, celery, and onion in hot oil over medium heat for 6 to 8 minutes or until tender. Remove from heat; cool to room temperature.
2. In a large bowl combine the apple mixture, ketchup, ½ teaspoon of the jerk seasoning, the salt, and pepper. Add bison; mix well. Shape mixture into four ¾-inch-thick patties.
3. Brush a grill pan or skillet with olive oil; heat pan over medium heat. Add patties to hot pan. Cook for 8 to 10 minutes or until done (160°F), turning once halfway through cooking.
4. In a small bowl stir together mayonnaise and the remaining ¼ teaspoon jerk seasoning; spread on Texas toast. Place toast slices on dinner plates. Top with leaf lettuce, burgers, and Cantaloupe and Strawberry Relish.

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK

### Dessert: Dark Chocolate Brownies

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 496*

PREP: 20 min | COOK: 4 hours on Low, plus 3 hours cooling | SERVES 16 as printed (half recipe below — serves 8) | Low-Calorie, Vegetarian

## Ingredients

- Nonstick cooking spray
- ¾ cup all-purpose flour (10 Tbsp)
- 2 tablespoons unsweetened extra-dark cocoa powder
- ¾ teaspoon baking powder
- ¼ teaspoon sea salt
- 4 ounces bittersweet chocolate, chopped
- ¼ cup unsalted butter, cut into small pieces
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs, beaten (recipe calls for 1½, round up)
- ½ cup dark chocolate chips

## Instructions

1. Spray a 3-quart slow cooker with nonstick cooking spray, line the bottom with parchment paper, and then spray the parchment paper.
2. In a medium bowl, whisk together the flour, cocoa powder, baking powder, and salt. Set aside.
3. In a large microwave-safe bowl, microwave the bittersweet chocolate and butter until the mixture is melted, stirring every 30 seconds.
4. Stir the sugar into the melted chocolate mixture and then mix in the beaten eggs.

5. Add the dry ingredients and chocolate chips to the wet ingredients and fold them in just until moistened. Do not overmix. Spoon the batter into the slow cooker.
6. Cover and cook on low for 3½ hours; then remove the lid and cook for another 30 minutes.
7. Remove the crock insert from the base. Run a knife around the edge of the brownies to loosen them. Let them cool in the crock for about 3 hours. The brownies won't look done at first, but they will be perfect after 3 hours of cooling.

## Cocktail: Mulled Wine

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 93*

PREP: 5 min | COOK: 2 hours on Low | SERVES 6 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Vegan

### Ingredients

- 2 (750-ml) bottles full-bodied red wine, such as pinot noir
- ½ cup granulated sugar
- 2 cinnamon sticks
- 2 orange slices
- 1 whole star anise (optional)

### Instructions

1. Place the wine, sugar, cinnamon sticks, orange slices, and star anise (if using) in a 3-quart slow cooker.
2. Cover and cook on low for 2 hours, or until the beverage is hot but not simmering.
3. Remove the cinnamon sticks, orange slices, and star anise (if used) before serving.

*INGREDIENT TIP: When you buy the red wine for this recipe, ask for German red wines like Franz Keller, Meyer-Nikel, or Bernhard Huber pinot noirs.*

## Week of Oct 18

### DINNERS THIS WEEK Breakfast Pizza

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 132*

PREP: 25 min | BAKE: 20 min at 375°F | MAKES: 10 servings

#### Ingredients

- 1 (16-ounce) loaf frozen whole wheat bread dough, thawed
- 1 cup halved zucchini slices and/or green or red sweet pepper pieces
- 1 cup sliced fresh mushrooms
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper (optional)
- 1 tablespoon vegetable oil
- 8 eggs
- ½ cup milk
- 1 tablespoon butter or margarine
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar and/or mozzarella cheese (6 ounces)
- 2 slices bacon, crisp-cooked, drained, and crumbled
- Bottled salsa (optional)

#### Instructions

1. Grease a 13-inch pizza pan; set aside. Preheat oven to 375°F. On a lightly floured surface roll bread dough into a 14-inch circle. Transfer dough to prepared pan. Build up edges slightly. Prick dough generously with a fork. Bake for 15 to 20 minutes or until light brown.
2. Meanwhile, in a large skillet cook zucchini, mushrooms, and, if desired, crushed red pepper in hot oil about 5 minutes or until vegetables are almost tender. Remove zucchini mixture and drain.
3. In a medium bowl beat together eggs and milk. In the same skillet melt butter over medium heat; pour in egg mixture. Cook, without stirring, until mixture begins to set on the bottom and around edges. Using a large spatula, lift and fold partially cooked eggs so uncooked portion flows underneath. Continue cooking over medium heat for 2 to 3 minutes or until egg mixture is cooked through but is still glossy and moist. Remove from heat.
4. Sprinkle half of the shredded cheese over the hot crust. Top with scrambled eggs, zucchini mixture, bacon, and remaining cheese. Bake for 5 to 8 minutes more or until cheese melts. Cut into 10 slices. If desired, serve with salsa.

### Farfalle with Mushrooms and Spinach

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 426*

START TO FINISH: 20 min | MAKES: 4 servings

## Ingredients

- 12 ounces packaged dried farfalle (bow tie) pasta (4 cups)
- 2 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 cup chopped onion (1 large)
- 2 cups sliced portobello or other fresh mushrooms
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 8 cups fresh baby spinach
- 2 teaspoons snipped fresh thyme
- ¼ teaspoon black pepper
- ¼ cup shredded Parmesan cheese (1 ounce)
- Crushed red pepper (optional)

## Instructions

1. In a 4-quart pot cook farfalle according to package directions; drain.
2. Meanwhile, in a very large skillet heat oil over medium heat. Add onion, mushrooms, and garlic; cook and stir for 2 to 3 minutes or until mushrooms are nearly tender. Stir in spinach, thyme, and pepper; cook about 1 minute or until heated through and spinach is slightly wilted. Stir in cooked pasta; toss gently to mix. Sprinkle with cheese. If desired, sprinkle with crushed red pepper.

# Vegetarian Lasagna

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 238*

PREP: 20 min | COOK: 4 hours on Low | SERVES 8 | Vegetarian

## Ingredients

- 8 cups Basic Marinara Sauce (or store-bought)
- 2 yellow onions, finely chopped
- 5 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tablespoon coarsely ground fennel seed
- Pinch red pepper flakes
- 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 16 ounces no-boil lasagna noodles
- 16 ounces cottage cheese
- 4 cups shredded mozzarella cheese, divided
- 1 cup grated Parmesan cheese
- 2 large eggs
- 2 cups roughly chopped fresh basil, divided

## Instructions

1. In a bowl, mix together the marinara sauce, onions, garlic, fennel seed, red pepper flakes, and oil. Ladle about ½ cup of the mixture into a 5-quart slow cooker (enough to thoroughly coat the bottom of the insert).
2. Arrange a layer of lasagna noodles in the slow cooker. Ladle additional sauce over the noodles.
3. In a large bowl mix the cottage cheese, 3½ cups of mozzarella cheese, the Parmesan cheese, and the eggs. Layer about half of the cheese mixture on top of the noodles. Top with 1 cup of basil.
4. Repeat with a layer of noodles, marinara sauce, the remainder of the cheese mixture, and the remaining 1 cup of basil.
5. Finish with the remaining pasta, marinara sauce, and the remaining ½ cup of mozzarella cheese.
6. Cover and cook on low for 4 hours, or until the noodles are tender and the lasagna is bubbling around the edges. Uncover and let rest for at least 15 minutes before serving.

*INGREDIENT TIP: In place of the cooked lasagna noodles, substitute no-boil noodles. That will save you about 10 minutes of preparation time. The slow cooker cooking time is the same. Just test the noodles with a fork before you serve the lasagna to make sure they are tender.*

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK **Dessert: Molten**

### **Chocolate Cakes**

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 279*

PREP: 30 min | COOL: 15 min | CHILL: 2 hours | BAKE: 15 min at 375°F | STAND: 10 min | MAKES: 8 cakes

#### **Ingredients**

- 1¼ cups semisweet chocolate pieces
- ½ cup whipping cream
- 1 tablespoon butter
- ¾ cup semisweet chocolate pieces
- ½ cup butter, cut up
- 4 eggs
- ½ cup sugar
- ½ cup all-purpose flour
- Unsweetened cocoa powder (optional)
- Fresh raspberries

#### **Instructions**

1. Generously butter eight 6-ounce ramekins or custard cups. For filling, in a small saucepan combine the 1¼ cups chocolate pieces, whipping cream, and the 1 tablespoon butter. Cook and stir over low heat until chocolate melts and mixture is smooth. Remove from heat. Cool for 15 minutes, stirring occasionally. Cover and chill about 2 hours or until it reaches a fudge like consistency.
2. Preheat oven to 375°F. In a saucepan combine ¾ cup chocolate pieces and ½ cup butter. Cook and stir over low heat until chocolate melts; cool slightly.
3. In a large mixing bowl beat eggs and sugar with an electric mixer on medium to high speed for 5 minutes. Beat in flour and cooled chocolate mixture. Spoon enough batter into each ramekin to measure 1 inch in depth.
4. Form chilled filling into eight portions. Working quickly, use your hands to roll each portion into a ball. Place a ball of filling on top of the batter in each ramekin; do not allow the filling to touch the sides of the ramekins. Gently spoon remaining batter over filling to cover.
5. Bake for 15 minutes. Remove from oven; let stand for 10 minutes. Using a knife, loosen cakes from sides of ramekins. If desired, dust with unsweetened cocoa powder. If desired, invert onto dessert plates. Serve immediately with fresh raspberries.

### **Cocktail: Cosmopolitan**

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 72*

Makes 1 serving

**Ingredients**

- ¼ cup (2 oz) vodka
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) orange liqueur
- 2 tablespoons (1 oz) cranberry juice
- 1 tablespoon (½ oz) lime juice
- Ice cubes
- Lime peel twist (garnish)

**Instructions**

1. In a cocktail shaker combine vodka, orange liqueur, cranberry juice, and lime juice. Add ice cubes; cover and shake until very cold. Strain into a chilled glass. If desired, garnish with a lime peel twist.

## Week of Oct 25

### DINNERS THIS WEEK

## Chicken Marsala

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 478*

PREP: 25 min | COOK: 11 min | MAKES: 4 servings

### Ingredients

- ¼ cup all-purpose flour
- ½ teaspoon dried thyme, crushed
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ⅛ teaspoon black pepper
- 4 skinless, boneless chicken breast halves (6 to 8 ounces each)
- 1 cup chicken broth
- ½ cup dry Marsala
- 3 tablespoons butter
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 2 cups sliced fresh button or cremini mushrooms
- 2 tablespoons finely chopped shallot
- Hot cooked pasta (optional)
- Snipped fresh Italian parsley

### Instructions

1. In a shallow dish stir together flour, thyme, salt, and pepper; set aside. Place each chicken breast half between two pieces of plastic wrap. Pound chicken lightly to about ¼ inch thick. Discard plastic wrap. Coat chicken pieces with flour mixture; shake off excess.
2. In a small bowl whisk together any remaining flour mixture, the broth, and Marsala; set aside.
3. In a very large skillet cook chicken in 1 tablespoon of the butter and the olive oil over medium-high heat for 4 to 6 minutes or until no longer pink, turning once. Transfer chicken to a platter; cover with foil to keep warm.
4. Add mushrooms and shallot to skillet; cook for 6 to 8 minutes until tender. Remove skillet from heat. Carefully add Marsala mixture to skillet. Return to heat. Cook and stir until slightly thickened and bubbly. Whisk in the remaining 2 tablespoons butter until incorporated. If desired, serve over pasta. Spoon mushroom sauce over chicken. Sprinkle with parsley.

## Chicken Piccata

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 286*



PREP: 15 min | COOK: 6 to 8 hours on Low or 3 to 4 hours on High | SERVES 4 | Gluten-Free, Low-Calorie, Weeknight Hero

### Ingredients

- 2 pounds boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- ½ teaspoon sea salt
- ⅛ teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- ¼ cup freshly squeezed lemon juice
- 3 tablespoons capers, undrained
- 1 bay leaf
- ¾ cup Chicken Stock (or store-bought)

### Instructions

1. Season the chicken with the salt and pepper. Place the chicken, lemon juice, capers, bay leaf, and stock in a 4-quart slow cooker. Stir to mix well.
2. Cover and cook on low for 6 to 8 hours or on high for 3 to 4 hours, until the chicken reads 165°F on a food thermometer.
3. Remove and discard the bay leaf before serving.

*GAME PLAN: If you cook extra chicken in this recipe (add up to another pound), you can use the leftovers for a chicken salad or sandwiches the next day.*

# Chicken Enchiladas

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 232*

PREP: 30 min | BAKE: 40 min at 350°F | MAKES: 6 servings

## Ingredients

- ¼ cup slivered almonds, toasted
- ¼ cup chopped onion
- 1 to 2 medium fresh jalapeño Chile peppers, seeded and chopped (optional)
- 2 tablespoons butter or margarine
- 1 (4-ounce) can diced green chiles, drained
- 1 (3-ounce) package cream cheese, softened
- 1 tablespoon milk
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin
- 3 cups chopped cooked chicken
- 12 (7-inch) flour tortillas or 6-inch corn tortillas
- 1 (10.75-ounce) can condensed cream of chicken or cream of mushroom soup
- 1 (8-ounce) carton sour cream
- 1 cup milk
- ¾ cup shredded Monterey Jack or cheddar cheese (3 ounces)
- Finely chopped jalapeño Chile peppers, snipped fresh cilantro, and/or sliced green onion(optional)

## Instructions

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. Grease a 3-quart rectangular baking dish; set aside. In a medium skillet cook the ¼ cup almonds, the onion, and, if desired, jalapeño peppers in hot butter over medium heat until onion is tender. Remove from heat. Stir in 1 tablespoon of the canned chiles; reserve remaining chiles for sauce.
2. In a medium bowl combine cream cheese, the 1 tablespoon milk, and cumin; add nut mixture and chicken. Stir until combined. Spoon about ¼ cup of the chicken mixture onto each tortilla; roll up. Place filled tortillas, seam sides down, in prepared baking dish; set aside.
3. In a medium bowl combine soup, sour cream, 1 cup milk, and reserved chiles. Pour over the tortillas in baking dish. Cover with foil.
4. Bake about 35 minutes or until heated through. Remove foil. Sprinkle enchiladas with cheese. Bake about 5 minutes more or until cheese melts. If desired, top with finely chopped jalapeño Chile peppers, snipped fresh cilantro, and/or sliced green onion.

## DESSERT & COCKTAIL OF THE WEEK

## Dessert: Pumpkin Bread Pudding

*The Ultimate Slow Cooker Cookbook, p. 503*

PREP: 25 min | COOK: 4 to 6 hours on Low | SERVES 8 | Vegetarian

### Ingredients

- 1 loaf store-bought pumpkin bread, cubed
- 1 cup dried cranberries
- 1 cup canned solid-pack pumpkin purée (not pumpkin pie filling)
- 1 cup half-and-half
- ¼ cup pumpkin butter
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 2 large egg yolks
- ⅓ cup unsalted butter, melted
- 2 teaspoons ground cinnamon
- ⅛ teaspoon ground nutmeg
- ⅛ teaspoon sea salt
- 1 cup Salted Almond-Caramel Sauce (optional)
- Ice cream, for serving (optional)

### Instructions

1. Place the pumpkin bread and dried cranberries in a 3½-quart slow cooker.
2. In a large bowl, mix the pumpkin purée with the half-and-half until smooth.
3. Stir in the pumpkin butter, brown sugar, eggs, egg yolks, butter, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt and mix until smooth. Pour the mixture into the slow cooker, making sure all the bread cubes are covered.
4. Cover and cook on low for 4 to 6 hours, or until a food thermometer registers 160°F.
5. Serve the pudding warm with the caramel sauce and ice cream, if you like.

## Cocktail: Vodka Gimlet

*Better Homes and Gardens New Cook Book, 16th Edition, p. 72*

Makes 1 serving

### Ingredients

- 3 tablespoons (1½ oz) vodka or gin
- 1 tablespoon (½ oz) lime juice
- Ice cubes

- Lime slices (garnish, optional)

**Instructions**

1. In a cocktail shaker combine vodka and lime juice. Add ice cubes; cover and shake until very cold. Strain into an ice-filled glass. If desired, garnish with lime slices.